Finland: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Finland's lowest Energy Security percentiles are in downstream gas and downstream oil, where it scores higher than only 0% and 14% of the other economies scored. Falling use per person pulls both scores down.[1]
- Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in downstream wind, midstream coal and midstream nuclear, higher than 97%, 96% and 95% of the other economies scored. Wind power production and use, and strong exports, push them up.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks upstream nuclear 1st among Finland's own sectors, almost tied with downstream batteries. Policy activity ranks the former only 13th and the latter 1st.[1,2]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates Sweden highest for Finland, as a reliable supplier; it is also its 1st trade partner. China, its 5th trade partner, ranks only 36th on Partnership Strength.[1,3]

1. Energy security risks and why

9 of Finland's 29 placed sectors sit in the two low-energy-security corners, below the middle economy of their sector on Energy Security, which measures how well a country can rely on what it needs. Its lowest Energy Security percentiles are in downstream gas (score 0.29, Secure corner) and downstream oil (0.47, Secure corner). There it scores higher than only 0% and 14% of the other 98 economies scored. Both scores are pulled down mainly by the energy access category, which measures use per person and its change. Over the years to 2025, gas use per person changed by -46.7%, to 7.17 GJ per person; oil use changed by -10.5%, to 58.1 GJ per person.[1,4]

Next comes upstream coal (0.26, Secure corner), higher than 18% of the other economies scored. It is held down by the energy imports category: production minus consumption was -0.0766 EJ in 2025. The figure takes production from the U.S. Energy Information Administration's international statistics, as the Energy Institute does not report it separately. For context, its largest suppliers of upstream coal in 2024 were the United States (40.8% of imports) and Australia (30.5%).[1,3,4,5]

Its high-priority sectors, upstream electric grid, midstream wind and downstream solar, sit in the Upgrade corner, which pairs high opportunity with low energy security. In midstream wind its Energy Security, higher than only 38% of the other economies scored, is held down mainly by the trade category. Its trade deficit in these goods was 0.3% of GDP in 2023. For context, its largest suppliers there were China (17.0%) and Germany (14.5%). In downstream solar the score is held down mainly by the reserves category: on solar resource potential it scores higher than only 8% of the other economies.[1,3,6]

2. Economic opportunities and why

24 of its 29 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners, above the middle economy of their sector on Economic Opportunity, which measures how well placed a country is to create value. Its highest Economic Opportunity percentiles are in downstream wind (0.58), midstream coal (0.54) and midstream nuclear (0.59). There it scores higher than 97%, 96% and 95% of the other economies scored. Each sits in the Grow corner, which the framework associates with building on strength through export promotion.[1]

In downstream wind the energy access and production categories push the score up. Wind power use per person rose by 178.6% over the years to 2025, to 15 GJ per person, and production reached 23.4 TWh. In the midstream sectors, the trade and cost competitiveness categories push the scores up. Its revealed comparative advantage was 3.29 in midstream coal and 3.07 in midstream nuclear in 2024. For context, its largest market for both baskets in 2024 was Indonesia (42.9% and 44.0%).[3,4,7]

In midstream wind, a high-priority sector, its Economic Opportunity is higher than 80% of the other economies scored. The foreign dependency category pushes it up: Finland carries the EU's announced share of world manufacturing capacity for 2035, 15.0%.[1,8]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by opportunity, security need, policy activity, stage and low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it ranks upstream nuclear 1st among Finland's own sectors, at 0.66. It is almost tied with downstream batteries, which trails it by only 0.001. The security-need term, which rises as Energy Security falls, contributes 0.246, more than any other part, while policy activity ranks it only 13th. Next comes upstream batteries (3rd), almost tied with downstream batteries (0.009 apart). Then come midstream batteries (4th) and upstream wind (5th), also almost tied (0.001).[1,2]

Finland's allied pick, its top upstream or midstream sector after a screen for resource endowment, is upstream nuclear, 0.025 ahead of midstream batteries.[9]

Policy activity counts International Energy Agency policy records and the Climate Action Tracker rating, which favours low-emission technologies over coal, oil and gas. Finland has 179 such records, 97 of which name a technology, and carries the European Union's Climate Action Tracker rating, Insufficient. Policy activity partly agrees with priority, which is the Strategic Index without its policy term. No top priority has the least policy; top priority and the most policy coincide in upstream batteries, midstream batteries and midstream solar. Among the top priorities, policy activity is weakest in upstream green hydrogen, in the top third on priority but only 18th on policy. Among the bottom priorities, the most policy goes to downstream wind and downstream green hydrogen, and the least to 7 coal, oil and gas sectors. For context, the Country Insights page lists, by sector, the strongest active industrial-policy measures that Global Trade Alert records under Finland, including EU-wide ones; they do not count towards policy activity.[1,2,10]

4. Partnership priorities and why

From Finland's viewpoint, the Partnership Strength Index rates Sweden highest, as a reliable supplier strongest in upstream electric grid, upstream solar, downstream wind, downstream solar and upstream gas. The index combines how reliable a supplier a partner is (Friendshore), how good a market it is (Partnership Opportunity) and, for lower-income partners, Development Potential. Germany ranks 2nd and the United States 3rd, both as a reliable supplier, followed by Belgium (4th, export market) and Norway (5th, reliable supplier).[1]

Today's ties largely match these ranks. Sweden, Germany and the United States are also its 1st, 2nd and 3rd trade partners on average across its energy-goods baskets, and Norway is its 6th. Belgium, by contrast, is only its 22nd. Sweden, Germany, the United States and Norway each share NATO and the Minerals Security Partnership with Finland. The reverse case is China: its 5th trade partner, it ranks 36th on Partnership Strength and rates best as a development partner. It shares none of Finland's economic-security agreements, and their UN votes put them in opposite blocs.[1,3,11,12]

As a partner to the coalition, Finland ranks 18th of 192 economies on Partnership Strength averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design its shares are derived from the European Union's: they are largest in upstream electric vehicles (1.4% of designed coalition production) and midstream coal (0.8%).[1,9]

5. Data notes and caveats

Figures are as of 12 October 2026. Scores compare Finland with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up. In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; Finland's shares are derived from its weight within the EU. The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; Finland carries the EU's rating. Finland's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records. Trade figures count trade with other EU members. Each EU member carries the EU's announced 2035 manufacturing-capacity shares and electric-vehicle figures.

Sources

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